U-C-115b

FEBRUARY 10, 1958

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. U-C-00115a (GSA-FSS)
April 17, 1956, and
Fed. Spec. U-C-115
December 23, 1943

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CAPSULE, GELATIN

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers gelatin capsules which are used in prescription practice, permitting a latitude of choice by prescribing either a single drug, or a combination of drugs, at the precise dosage level considered best for the individual patient by the physician or veterinarian.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Type and sizes.* — Gelatin capsules shall be "hard-capsule" type and in the following sizes, as specified (see 6.2).

Size—000	Size—2
Size— 00	Size—3
Size— 0	Size—4
Size— 1	Size—5

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards.—The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-585—Boxes; Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 — Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-676—Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-B-10377—Box, Wood, Cleated, Veneer, Paper Overlaid.
MIL-L-10547 — Liners, Case, Waterproof.

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129 — Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications.—The following publication, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, forms a part of this specification:

United States Pharmacopoeia Convention Publication:

Pharmacopoeia of the United States.

(The Pharmacopoeia of the United States is published by the Mack Printing Company, Easton, Pennsylvania).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. — The U.S.P. XV lists two types of gelatin, "Type A" and "Type B". Manufacturers should be contacted to determine which type is being used in the manufacture of their hard capsules.

3.2 Capsules shall conform to the following requirements.

3.2.1 *Shape and construction.* — Capsules shall be uniform, trimmed to true size, shall be practically cylindrical with tapered walls and rounded ends. Each capsule consists of a base and a smooth-fitting cap. The cap shall overlap not less than 40 percent of the base and shall maintain a tight friction closure.

3.2.2 *Capacity of size.*—The capsules shall have the approximate capacities as shown when lightly packed with any one of the drugs listed in table I.

3.2.3 *Chemical and physical properties.*

3.2.3.1 *Water resistance.* — The capsules shall show no signs of disintegration when tested in accordance with 4.3.

3.2.3.2 *Acid solubility.*—The capsules shall completely fall apart, dissolve, or disintegrate, when tested in accordance with 4.4.

3.2.3.3 *Appearance and color.*—The capsules shall be clear, have a uniform appearance and be free from foreign matter. Unless otherwise specified, the capsules shall not be colored.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling.

4.1.1 *For visual inspection.* — Sampling procedures for visual inspection shall be conducted in accordance with the procedures set forth in Military Standard MIL-STD-105.

4.1.2 *For tests.*—From each lot or control number, select one box from one case randomly selected. If additional sample(s) is required to perform the tests, the sample(s) shall be taken from a different case(s).

4.2 Inspection. — Inspection may be made throughout the entire process of manufacture. The passing as satisfactory of any detail of construction or materials shall not relieve the contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance. Final inspection of the finished article shall be made either at point of production or at point of delivery, as specified (see 6.2). In case of factory inspection, every facility shall be afforded inspectors, by the manufacturer, for the prosecution of their work.

4.3 Water resistance test. — Samples of empty closed capsules shall be immersed in distilled water at 20° Centigrade (C.) to 30° C. for 15 minutes.

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TABLE I.

Capsule size (capacity)	000	00	0	1	2	3	4	5
Quinine sulphate, needle crystals, grains	10	6	5	3½	3	2	1½	1
Sodium bicarbonate, powdered, grains	22	15	11	8	6	5	4	2
Acetylsalicylic acid, powdered, grains	16	10	8	5	4	3	2½	1½
Bismuth subnitrate, powdered, grains	28	20	14	10	8	6	4	2

4.4 Acid solubility test.—Samples of empty closed capsules shall be immersed in 0.5 percent, by weight, aqueous hydrochloric acid solution at 36° C. to 38° C. and allowed to remain at this temperature for 5 minutes.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 *Unit of issue.*—The number of capsules specified in table II constitute one unit of issue.

5.1.2 *Quantities.*—Packaging and packing quantities shall be as specified in table II.

5.1.2.1 *Packing variation permitted.* — If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which will insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 *Level A.*

5.1.3.1 *Unit package.*

5.1.3.1.1 *Carton.*—Each unit shall be packaged in a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with Federal Specification PPP–B–676.

5.1.3.1.2 *Wrapper.*—Each unit carton shall be overwrapped in cellulose acetate, waxed paper, or waterproof paper of suitable weight. Wrapper shall be completely sealed.

5.1.3.2 *Intermediate package.*—The number of unit packages specified in table II shall be packaged in a carton of appropriate size and design, or shall be completely wrapped with kraft paper of suitable weight. Carton or wrapping shall be adequately secured to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.4 *Level C.*—Capsules of the same size shall be packed in suitable cardboard boxes as follows:

Sizes 000–5—100 capsules to the carton.

TABLE II.—*Packaging and packing quantities*

Stock number	Number of capsules constituting one unit of issue	Number of unit cartons to be contained in each intermediate package	Number of intermediate packages to be overpacked in each shipping container	Total number of units to be contained in each shipping container
6505–112–4510	100	12	24	288
6505–112–4511	100	12	24	288
6505–112–4512	100	12	24	288
6505–112–4515	100	12	24	288
6505–164–6294	100	12	24	288

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Twelve cardboard boxes, containing the capsules of the same size only, shall be wrapped in heavy paper or in a suitable cardboard packer and sealed.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 *Level A.*

5.2.1.1 *Exterior container.*—The number of intermediate packages specified in table II shall be overpacked in an exterior container designed for type 2 load and constructed in accordance with Federal Specification PPP-B-585, style 3, for class 3 use; PPP-B-601, table II, using type III, class 1 plywood; PPP-B-621, table III; or Military Specification MIL-B-10377, table II.

5.2.1.2 *Case liner.*—Each level A box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to Military Specification MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto.

5.2.1.3 *Strapping.*—Strapping (when required) shall be in accordance with applicable box specification.

Note.—Strapping will not be required for shipment forwarded to a receiving activity within the continental limits of the United States for storage and redistribution.

5.2.2 *Level B.*

5.2.2.1 *Exterior container.*—The number of intermediate packages specified in table II shall be overpacked in an exterior container conforming to Federal Specification PPP-B-601, table I, using class 1 plywood; or an exterior container designed for type 2 load and constructed in accordance with Federal Specification PPP-B-585, style 3, for class 2 use; PPP-B-621, table I; or Military Specification MIL-B-10377, table I.

5.2.3 *Level C.* — The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to the point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Unit carton.*—Each unit carton shall be marked with the item identification, lot or control number designated as such "Lot No. —" or "Control No. —", and name of contractor. If the unit carton overwrap is not transparent, it shall be marked as above.

5.3.2 *Intermediate package.*—Each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with section 5 of Military Standard MIL-STD-129.

5.3.3 *Shipping container.*—Shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-129. Service color and service symbol markings are required only on direct shipments from contractor's plant to overseas activities. In addition, shipping container shall bear the statement "DO NOT STORE NEAR HEAT."

6. NOTES

6.1 Federal Standard No. 102 should be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging protection for supplies and equipment.

6.2 Ordering data. — Purchasers should specify the size required and should exercise any desired options offered herein. (See paragraphs 1.2.1, 3.2, 3.3, 4.2, 5.1, 5.2 and 5.3).

6.3 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

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6.4 This specification does not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodity indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types, etc., normally procured to meet Federal Government requirements.

6.5 Transportation description.—Transportation description applicable to this item is:

Capsules, gelatin.

Carload minimum weight 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor volume minimum weight 20,000 pounds.

6.6 This specification covers the following items appearing in the Armed Services Medical Stock List:

6505–112–4510—CAPSULE, GELATIN, Pharmaceutical, No. 0, 100s.

6505–112–4511—CAPSULE, GELATIN, Pharmaceutical, No. 1, 100s.

6505–112–4512—CAPSULE, GELATIN, Pharmaceutical, No. 2, 100s.

6505–112–4515—CAPSULE, GELATIN, Pharmaceutical, No. 3, 100s.

6505–164–6294—CAPSULE, GELATIN, Pharmaceutical, No. 00, 100s.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility, nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise, as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTEREST:
Army—M
Navy—Md
Air Force—AF.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

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